Iteration C3: Using a Helper to Format the Price

Ruby provides a `sprintf` function that can be used to format prices. We could place logic that makes use of this function directly in the view. For example, we could say this:

```
<%= sprintf("$%0.02f", product.price) %>
```

That would work, but it embeds knowledge of currency formatting into the view. If we display prices of products in several places and want to internationalize the application later, this would be a maintenance problem.

Instead, let's use a helper method to format the price as a currency. Rails has an appropriate one built in, called `number_to_currency`.

Using our helper in the view is just a matter of invoking it as a regular method; in the index template, this is the code we start with:

```
<%= product.price %>
```

We can change it to the following:

rails80/depot_e/app/views/store/index.html.erb

```
<%= number_to_currency(product.price) %>
```

When we refresh, we see a nicely formatted price, as shown in the screenshot.